



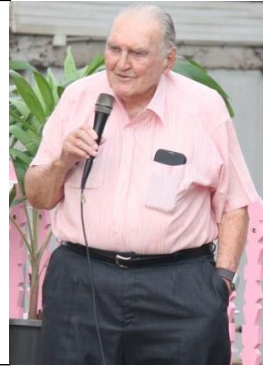
The Garamut “The message sender”

Ps Barry Reflections from ‘The WORD’!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL
PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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THE WINDS OF LIFE

Song of Solomon 4:16 "Come, north wind, awaken; come, south wind, blow upon my garden and waft its lovely perfume to my beloved. Let him come into his garden and eat its choicest fruits." (TLB)

Song of Solomon 4:16 *Awake, north wind, and come, south wind! Blow on my garden, that its fragrance may spread abroad. Let my lover come into his garden and taste its choice fruits. NIV*

BETTER IS THE WIND OF GOD'S GRACE THAN THE WIND OF INDIFFERENCE.

Summary – symbolism.

The woman is the bride betrothed to her Shepherd King.

Her lover is a Shepherd King - her bridegroom.

The Garden - Figuratively is herself – her own life. She speaks of the garden as his - as her lover's garden (ownership) – e.g. She is serving him and is submitted to his purposes.

The fruits & spices are the spiritual things (graces) that have become part the spiritual growth in her own life.

The north wind - signifies harsh trials, adversity, and purifying cold winds that strengthen character.

The south wind - represents gentle, warm, and nourishing blessings that bring comfort, growth and joy.

The winds represent (type of) the events, that happen in our lives as followers of Christ – the good, the unpleasant, the blessings, the trials and testings of our faith and resolve to continue on.

These winds are opposites in their **origin**, **nature** and **function** in what they bring to this earth / her garden.

This woman is not concerned where the wind comes from or its nature (hot / dry – cold / rain & snow), she is only focused on the wind providing a function for her – to be an instrument to fulfill her passionate desire for her lover to smell the fragrances' of the spices and fruit of the garden, and be attracted to come to his garden (her life) to partake.

The analogy

* **The spice and fruit of the garden is a picture of Christ at work in the believer producing change, alignment to God's will and developing Godly character and spiritual graces of that reflect the person of Christ.**

IT DOESN'T MATTER WHAT KIND OF WIND IT IS AS LONG AS GOD IS IN THE WIND.

THE WIND OF GOD'S GRACE.

Even though it comes with spiritual heat or coldness, fire or snow is still better than the wind of indifference.

BUT THERE ARE OTHER KINDS OF WINDS THAT BLOW ON THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST AND HIS FOLLOWERS.

1. THE WIND OF INDIFFERENCE:

The wind of indifference, apathy, a lack of interest and concern – uncaring, neutral unattached about someone or something.

2. THE WIND OF COMPLACENCY:

Self-satisfaction having no desire to improve or expand their desires, horizons, especially when accompanied by unawareness of actual dangers or deficiencies.

3. THE WIND OF NEUTRALITY:

An impartial, unbiased state of mind. Neutrality is the state of not supporting or helping either side in a conflict, dispute etc characterized by impartiality and non-interference.
It involves maintaining an unbiased, detached position.

4. THE WIND OF MEDIOCRITY:

The quality of being average, ordinary, or not very good and often implying a disappointing standard on a scale somewhere closer to poor quality rather than high.
It describes a state of "just getting by" or producing unimpressive work, meaning "only fair to rather poor" or average quality.

5. THE WIND OF COMPROMISE:

Negotiating, bargaining, make concessions – meeting each other halfway - find the middle ground, make a deal - the acceptance of standards that are lower than is desirable.

6. THE WIND OF FALSEHOOD:

Falsehood is the state of being untrue, a deliberate lie, or a false statement. It refers to the act of deception, misrepresentation, or a lack of conformity to reality. Lack of truthfulness, integrity, honesty and accountability before God and man.

7. THE WIND OF IMMORALITY:

Immorality is behaviour that violates accepted moral laws, standards, or ethical principles, often characterized as evil, sinful, or corrupt. It refers to actions, thoughts, or systems deemed socially unacceptable or harmful, such as dishonesty, injustice, or sexual misconduct.

Isaiah 8:20 To the law and to the testimony! If they do not speak according to this word, it is because there is no light in them. NKJV

8. THERE IS WIND OF FALSE DOCTRINE:

That seeks to deceive through trickery.

Old Testament – not consistent with the God's outlined in the Pentateuch – (the first five books of the Bible).

New Testament - misrepresenting the apostle's doctrine.

Ephesians 4:14 that we should no longer be children, tossed to and fro and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the trickery of men, in the cunning craftiness of deceitful plotting. NKJV

Ephesians 4:14 That we henceforth be no more children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the sleight of men, and cunning craftiness, whereby they lie in wait to deceive. KJV

Song of Solomon 4:16:

GOD IS IN THE WIND.

WHETHER BRINGING HARSH ADVERSITY (NORTH) OR GENTLE BLESSING (SOUTH), GOD UTILIZES ALL WINDS TO CARRY THE FRAGRANCE OF THE PLEASANT FRUITS OF THE BELIEVER'S LIFE TRANSFORMED BY THE INDWELLING CHRIST.

REGARDLESS OF THEIR NATURE, GOD USES ALL OF LIFE'S CIRCUMSTANCES TO SPREAD THE AROMA OF THE BELIEVER'S SPIRITUAL GRACES, WHICH ARE DEVELOPED BY THE WORKING OF CHRIST WITHIN.

BRUISED HERBS SEND FORTH THE SWEETEST SMELL, STORMY WIND AND SUNSHINE ALIKE ARE USED BY GOD TO BRING OUT THE AROMA OF A CONSECRATED LIFE.

Philippians 2:13-16 [Not in your own strength] for it is God Who is all the while effectually at work in you [energizing and creating in you the power and desire], both to will and to work for His good pleasure and satisfaction and delight. AMP

IT IS GOD WHO IS CONTINUALLY AT WORK IN US.

1. ENERGIZING US WITH POWER, 2. CREATING DESIRE IN US AND

3. ALIGNING OUR LIVES 4. TO BOTH WILL HIS WILL – 5. AND WORK HIS WORK

Amen Ps Barry